

Siri sends money

Apple's Siri can now send and request payments using simple voice commands via PayPal from your iPhones and iPads. <http://dgit.in/siriPyPl>



Alexa, the talking fish!

Although the creator doesn't disclose how he did it, a developer (Brain Kane) hacked Amazon's Alexa into working with a singing toy fish! <http://dgit.in/alxafsh>

Origins

and was improved on the Contax S a year later with the first implementation of a pentaprism. During this time the Hasselblad 1600F was introduced, which went on to set the standards for SLRs for years to come.

A number of Japanese camera makers entered the camera market in the 1950s – Canon, Yashica, and Nikon. Nikon also brought the Nikon F camera with a full range of interchangeable accessories and components, which was the first of its kind.

Instant cameras

A new type of camera came into the market in 1948. Edwin Land introduced the Polaroid Model 95, the first instant camera, that could produce finished positive prints from negatives exposed in under a minute. It was known as the Land Camera after its creator. These cameras caught on despite their high prices and eventually, in 1965, one of the most popular cameras of all time, the Model 20 Swinger was launched and was a huge success.

Something that is quite normal in cameras these days is automatic exposure adjustment. This was introduced as early as 1938 in the Super Kodak Six 20 pack, but it was too expensive at \$225 (around \$3700 in present day value) to be popular. But around 1960s low-cost electronic components were available that made it feasible to put light meters into cameras.



Polaroid Land Camera Model 95

Going digital

Digital cameras are something that turned the world of photography on its head. Early models were used in satellites, with low resolutions, using charge-coupled device (CCD) arrays. The first recorded attempt at developing a digital camera was in 1975 at Eastman Kodak by Steven Sasson, an engineer at the company. This was a prototype camera that weighed around 3.6 kgs and took 23 seconds to capture its first image in black and white onto a cassette tape.



The Casio QV-10

Analog electronic cameras were the precursors to true digital cameras. The Canon RC-701 was launched in the market in 1986. Prior to that, it was demonstrated in 1984 during the Summer Olympics with pictures being printed in Yomiuri Shinbun, a Japanese newspaper. As it initially happens with any new technology, these cameras didn't gain much popularity due to the expenses involved and the inferior quality compared to the film format. They were experimented with in news organisations and military surveillance programs because of the speed of image transfers.

The first portable digital camera came around in 1989. It was the DS-X by Fuji which was sold in Japan. For the United States, the first commercially available digital camera was the Dycam Model 1 shipped in 1990. The introduction of the compression standards JPEG and MPEG played a large role in the adoption of digital cameras because they solved a huge problem – storage.

In 1995, the first commercial camera with a digital LCD screen on the back, the Casio QV-10, came out. In the same

year the Ricoh RDC-1 was released and was the first camera able to record video clips. The best launch of 1995 was the Minolta RD-175, because it was the first digital SLR (DSLR). Pretty soon, in 1999, Nikon introduced the D1, a 2.74 megapixel digital SLR developed from ground up by Nikon. Due to the entry of major manufacturers, prices fell to within the grasp of professional photographers. Another key factor was that most digital SLRs worked with the existing lenses that photographers already had for their analog SLRs.

Further advancements drove digital camera sales through the roof. Multiple film camera companies who could not adapt to the switch have since shut shop. Film is only used by aficionados now, and even entry-level digital cameras are being killed by amazing quality cameras in smartphones.

The perfect shot?

Cameras have meant more than just devices to us over the years. Some might say, that cameras have been instrumental in recording humanity and its progress through the ages. This device has been showing us everything from our mistakes to our achievements, reliving happy memories and



A DSLR has now made it easier for anyone to take great photographs

even sad ones. Now we are headed into the world of 360 degree cameras that can record everything around you at once for viewing in VR. Then there are cameras on drones and smart glasses that have software behind them that enables them to do things like object tracking. The future of photography is exciting, and who knows where it will take us. And to think it all started with a humble pinhole setup. 